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Chest with quick access cover

Abstract

A stackable storage system is disclosed. The system includes a base storage container disposed on a wheeled cart, and one or more additional storage containers removably secured on top of the base container. A main lid is disposed on the storage container and is pivotable between a position in which it covers at least a portion of the interior storage volume and a position in which it does not cover the interior storage volume. The main lid has a main lid opening formed therethrough. A secondary lid is pivotable between a position in which it covers the opening and a second position in which it does not cover the opening to allow access to the interior storage volume via the opening while the main lid covers the interior storage volume.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION (1) This application claims priority to U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/382,172, filed on Nov. 3, 2022, all titled “CHEST WITH QUICK ACCESS COVER”. The entire contents are hereby incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

(1) The present invention relates to a chest which may form part of a stackable storage container system which include a plurality of storage containers which may be secured to each other for joint movement by a wheeled cart and which allows for access to the interior of the chest while storage containers are stacked on a portion of the cover of the chest.

BACKGROUND

(2) Stackable storage containers are known, for example, the rolling container assembly shown in U.S. Pat. Nos. 8,132,819 and 9,132,543, which are hereby incorporated by reference. The assembly disclosed therein includes a base storage container which is disposable on a cart which is provided with wheels and an integral handle system. At least one further storage container may be removably

attached on top of the base container, allowing for multiple containers to be jointly transported. The mechanism for attaching the containers to each other may include a stacking latch mechanism, for example, as shown in U.S. Patent Application Publication No. 2020/0025229 which is hereby incorporated by reference. The mechanism includes a spring loaded pivotable latch having a hook disposed on the lid of the container and a step formed on the lower housing of the container. The latch includes a hook which is selectively disposed over the step and thereby secure the containers together. U.S. Pat. No. 8,505,729 discloses a stackable container system in which each container includes a latch member and a ledge formed on the outer surface. The latch of a lower container is foldable over the ledge of an upper container to secure the upper and lower containers together.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(3) In a first embodiment the invention is directed to a chest having a storage body defining an interior storage volume and a main lid pivotable between a first main lid position in which the main lid covers the interior storage volume and a second main lid position in which the main lid does not cover the interior storage volume. The main lid has a main lid opening formed therethrough and a main lid ledge. A secondary lid is pivotable between a first secondary lid position in which the secondary lid covers the main lid opening and a second secondary lid position in which the secondary lid does not cover the main lid opening to allow access to the interior storage volume while the main lid is in the first main lid position. A secondary lid latch is secured to the secondary lid and is movable between a first secondary lid latch position in which the secondary lid latch secures the secondary lid to the main lid and a second secondary lid latch position in which the secondary lid latch does not secure said the secondary lid to the main lid. A container latch is secured to the secondary lid and is movable between a first container latch position in which the secondary latch is precluded from moving between the first secondary lid latch position and the second secondary latch position and a second container latch position in which the secondary latch is not precluded from moving between the first secondary lid latch position and the second secondary latch position.

(4) In a further embodiment, the invention is directed to a chest having a storage body defining an interior storage volume and a main lid having a main lid opening formed therethrough. A secondary lid is disposed on the main lid and is movable between a first secondary lid position where it covers the main lid opening and a second secondary lid position where it does not cover the main lid opening. A first latch is disposed on the secondary lid and releasably secures an external container to the secondary lid. A secondary latch is movable between a first secondary latch position in which it secures the secondary lid in the first secondary lid position and second secondary latch position in which it does not secure the secondary lid in the first secondary lid position.

(5) In a still further embodiment, the invention is directed to a stackable system including a chest and a container. The container includes a step. The chest includes a storage body defining an interior storage volume. A main lid is pivotable between a first main lid position in which the main lid covers the interior storage volume and a second main lid position in which the main lid does not cover the interior storage volume. The main lid has a main lid opening formed therethrough and a main lid ledge. A secondary lid is pivotable between a first secondary lid position in which the secondary lid covers the main lid opening and a second secondary lid position in which the secondary lid does not cover the main lid opening to allow access to the interior storage volume while the main lid is in the first main lid position. A secondary lid latch is secured to the secondary lid. The secondary lid latch is movable between a first secondary lid latch position in which the secondary lid latch secures the secondary lid to the main lid and a second secondary lid latch position in which the secondary lid latch does not secure the secondary lid to the main lid. A container latch is secured to the secondary lid. The container latch includes a latch tooth and is movable between a first container latch position in which the latch tooth may overlie the step to secure the container to the secondary lid when the container is disposed on the secondary lid and a second position in which the latch tooth does not overlie the step to allow the container to be

removed from the secondary lid. When the container latch is in the first container latch position with the container disposed on the secondary lid, the secondary lid latch is precluded from moving between the first secondary lid latch position and the second secondary lid latch position.

(6) These and other objects, features, and characteristics of the present invention, as well as the methods of operation and functions of the related elements of structure and the combination of parts will become more apparent upon consideration of the following description and the appended claims with reference to the accompanying drawings, all of which form a part of this specification, wherein like reference numerals designate corresponding parts in the various figures. It is to be expressly understood, that the drawings are for the purpose of illustration and description only, and are not intended as a definition of the limits of the invention. In addition, it should be appreciated that structural features shown or described in any one embodiment herein can be used in other embodiments as well. As used in the specification and in the claims, the singular form of “a”, “an”, and “the” include plural references unless the context clearly dictates otherwise.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of a chest according to the invention.
- (2) FIG. 1A is a close-up opposite side perspective view of the chest shown in FIG. 1 with the secondary lid removed.
- (3) FIG. 2 is a perspective view of the chest shown in FIG. 1 with the main lid thereof in the open position.
- (4) FIG. 3 is a perspective of the chest shown in FIG. 1 with the main lid in the closed position and a secondary lid in the open position.
- (5) FIG. 4 is a perspective view of the main lid shown in FIG. 1.
- (6) FIG. 5 is a close-up perspective view of a secondary lid shown in FIG. 1.
- (7) FIG. 5A is an opposite side perspective view of the secondary lid shown in FIG. 5.
- (8) FIG. 6 is a perspective view of a secondary lid latch forming part of the invention.
- (9) FIG. 7 is an opposite side perspective view of the secondary lid latch shown in FIG. 6.
- (10) FIG. 8 is a side view of the secondary lid latch shown in FIGS. 6-7.
- (11) FIG. 9 is a perspective view of a container latch forming part of the invention
- (12) FIG. 10 is a further perspective view of the container latch shown in FIG. 9.
- (13) FIG. 11 is a close-up perspective view of a portion of the secondary lid shown in FIG. 5 with the secondary lid latch not shown.
- (14) FIG. 12 is a perspective view of a buckle latch forming part of the invention.
- (15) FIG. 12A is a close-up perspective view showing a portion of the chest shown in FIG. 1 with the buckle latch not shown.
- (16) FIG. 13 is a perspective of the chest having storage containers stacked and secured thereon according to the invention.
- (17) FIG. 14 is a perspective view of the chest having two storage containers stacked and secured on the main lid thereof and showing the secondary lid in the open position.
- (18) FIG. 15A is a perspective close-up view showing the secondary lid having a container stacked thereon.
- (19) FIG. 15B is a perspective cross sectional view showing the second lid having a container stacked thereon with the container latch in a first position.
- (20) FIG. 15C is a perspective cross sectional view showing the secondary lid having a container stacked thereon with the container latch in a second position.
- (21) FIG. 15D is a perspective cross sectional view showing the secondary lid having a container stacked thereon with the container latch in a second position and the secondary lid latch rotated.

(22) FIG. 16 is a perspective view of a container which can be secured to the chest shown in FIG. 1.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF EXEMPLARY EMBODIMENTS

(23) With reference to FIGS. 1-3, a chest with a quick access cover is disclosed. Chest 1 includes storage body 10 having two opposite end walls 13 and two opposite side walls 15. For sake of description end walls 13 may be deemed left and right end walls and side walls 15 may be deemed front and rear end walls, in relation to how they are situated in FIG. 1. Other elements of the invention may also be deemed as having left, right, front or rear sides consistent with the description of end walls 13 and side walls 15. Conventional telescoping extendable handle 17 is disposed at an upper edge of right end wall 13 and conventional wheels 11 are disposed at the corners created by the left end wall 13 and both side walls 15 to allow chest 1 to be wheeled. Storage body 10 defines interior storage volume 16 and has ledge 12 formed at the upper periphery of end walls 13 and side walls 15. Conventional buckle latches 14 are disposed on front side wall 15.

(24) With reference to FIG. 1A, storage body 10 includes main lid 20 having tabs 20(a) which further have holes formed therethrough at the rear thereof. Rear side wall 15 has tabs 15(a) also having holes formed therethrough. Tabs 15(a) and 20(a) are interlaced. Pivot rod 70 extends through the holes in tabs 15(a) and 20(a) to pivotably secure main lid 20 to rear side wall 15 to allow main lid 20 to pivot between a closed position in which it fully covers interior storage volume 16 and an open position in which it does not cover interior storage volume 16 to allow user access thereto to remove or replace tools or other items.

(25) With further reference to FIGS. 3-4, main lid 20 includes full thickness portion 22 generally forming the left side thereof and partial thickness portion 23 generally forming the right side thereof. Full thickness portion 22 includes front and rear full depth cutouts 28 formed therein. Front cutout 28 is disposed above left buckle latch 14 secured on storage body 10 and includes left main lid ledge 21(a) extending downwardly therefrom and left and right openings 28(a) formed on opposite interior side walls of cutout 28 at upper locations. (Only one opening 28(a) is shown in the Figures.) Container latch 40 is pivotably disposed in front cutout 28 via pivot pins which extend through latches 40 and into openings 28(a). Rear cutout 28 also includes left and right openings 28(a) into which a further container latch 40 is pivotably disposed, as does rear cutout 28' formed in secondary lid 24.

(26) With further reference to FIG. 11, main lid 20 includes opening 26 extending through partial thickness portion 23. Partial thickness portion 23 further includes partial depth cutout 27 formed in the front thereof. Main lid 20 includes secondary lid locking ledge 29 extending across partial depth cutout 27 and defining open region 29(b) underneath. At the left and right lateral ends, open region 29(b) extends further into partial thickness portion 23 to create secondary lid locking ledge openings 29(a). Partial depth cutout 27 also includes right main lid ledge 21(b) extending downwardly therefrom and laterally thereacross.

(27) With further reference to FIGS. 5 and 5A, secondary lid 24 includes rear tabs 24(a) having holes through which pivot rod 70 passes to allow secondary lid 24 to pivot relative to both main lid 20 and storage body 10, about the same axis as main lid 20 pivots relative to storage body 10. Secondary lid 24 is pivotable relative to main lid 20 between a position in which it covers opening 26 in main lid 20 as shown in FIG. 1 and a position in which it uncovers opening 26 as shown in FIG. 3. In the uncovered position of secondary lid 24, a user may access interior storage volume 16 even while full thickness portion 22 of main lid 20 remains in the horizontal position covering a portion of interior storage volume 16. Secondary lid arm 80 extend between the underside of secondary lid 24 and an upper surface of main lid 20 to allow secondary lid 24 to be secured in the fully open position. When secondary lid 24 is in the closed position, the upper surface of secondary lid 24 is co-planar to the upper surface of full thickness portion 22 of main lid 20. When secondary lid 24 is pivoted to the lower closed position, a lower end of secondary lid arm 80 slides in a

channel formed along the interior of the upper right side edge **13** of storage body **10**, with secondary lid arm **80** disposed through an opening formed in main lid **20**. A suitable stopper may be disposed on the lower end of secondary lid arm **80** to allow for the sliding.

(28) With further reference to FIGS. **1**, **5** and **11**, secondary lid **24** includes secondary lid full depth cutout **28'** formed on the rear edge thereof and having substantially the same structure as main lid full depth cutouts **28**. A further container latch **40** is pivotably disposed in secondary lid full depth cutout **28'** in the same manner as container latches **40** are disposed in full depth cutout **28**.

Secondary lid **24** includes partial depth cutout **25** in the front edge thereof and located above partial depth cutout **27** of main lid **20** such that cutout **25** and cutout **27** form a single contiguous cutout located above right side buckle latch **14**. With further reference to FIG. **11**, cutout **25** includes lateral side walls into which holes **36** are formed (only the right side hole is shown in the figure.) Pivot pins **35** are secured in and extend through holes **36**. Inwardly extending openings **25(a)** are formed in cutout **25** on the upper lateral sides thereof. Cutout **25** also includes surface **25(d)** extending thereacross and having lateral circular indents **25(e)** (one shown) formed therein.

(29) With reference to FIGS. **6-8**, secondary lid latch **30** is shown and includes longitudinally extending main body **32** having side portions or arms **31** formed on each lateral end. Side portions **31** include secondary lid latch lower teeth **31(a)** projecting inwardly (relative to cutout **27** in main lid **20**) from a lower inward end and secondary lid latch upper teeth **38** projecting inwardly (relative to secondary lid **24** cutout **25**) from an upper inward end. Holes **34** are formed on and through both side portions **31** at a middle location, and holes **36** are formed on and through both side portions **31** at an upper location.

(30) Secondary lid latch **30** is pivotably secured in partial depth cutout **25** of secondary lid **24** of via pivot pins **35** which are disposed in holes **34**, with lower lid latch teeth **31(a)** extending below secondary lid **24** and into cutout **27** of main lid **20** at a location below secondary lid locking ledge **29**. In particular, secondary lid lower latch teeth **31(a)** are disposed in open region **29(b)** adjacent secondary lid locking ledge openings **29(a)**. Secondary lid latch upper teeth **38** are disposed in cutout **25** of secondary lid **24** adjacent openings **25(a)**. When secondary lid latch **30** is in a first position disposed about pins **35** such that the upper end thereof is disposed in an outer position relative to secondary lid **24**, secondary lid lower latch teeth **31(a)** are disposed inwardly into openings **29(a)**, below secondary lid locking ledge **29**. When secondary lid latch **30** is in a second position disposed about pins **35** such that the upper end thereof is positioned inwardly relative to secondary lid **24**, secondary lid latch upper teeth **38** are disposed into openings **25(a)** while secondary lid latch lower teeth **31(a)** are positioned outwardly of secondary lid locking ledge **29**. Therefore, when secondary lid latch **30** is in the first position as shown in FIG. **1**, the positioning of lower latch teeth **31(a)** below locking ledge **29** locks secondary lid **24** to main lid **20** in the closed position to cover opening **26**.

(31) In order to release secondary lid **24** from main lid **20**, main body **32** is grasped and pushed upwardly to move secondary lid latch into the second position allowing secondary lid lower latch teeth **31(a)** to move outwardly clear from secondary lid locking ledge **29** to unlock secondary lid **24** from main lid **20**, and allow secondary lid **24** to be pivoted to the upper position to provide access to interior storage volume **16**. With reference to FIG. **15C**, coil springs **53** (only one shown) are disposed between circular openings **32(a)** formed in secondary lid latch main body **32** and indents **25(e)** formed in surface **25(d)**. Secondary lid latch **30** may be pivoted about pins **35** between the first and second positions with coil springs **53** biasing secondary lid latch **30** into the first position to lock secondary lid **24** to main lid **20**.

(32) With reference to FIGS. **9-10**, container latch **40** is shown. Latch **40** includes cylindrical lower portion **41** having left and right through hole **45** formed therein. Upper portion **42** projects upwardly from cylindrical lower portion **41** and includes overhanging latches **44** projecting inwardly (relative to main lid **20** or secondary lid **24** when disposed thereon) on lateral sides thereof. Each latch **44** includes latch tooth **44(a)**. As noted above one container latch **40** is

pivotably disposed in one of main lid cutouts **28** and may be pivoted so that teeth **44(a)** are disposed above ledge **50(a)** formed on container **50** shown in FIG. **17** to secure container **50** to the left upper surface of main lid **24**. Container latches **40** may also be pivoted outwardly to remove teeth **44(a)** from ledge **50(a)** to allow container **50** to be removed.

(33) With further reference to FIGS. **5**, **11** and **12A**, a further container latch **40** is pivotably disposed above main body **32** of secondary lid latch **30**, between side portions **31** via pivot pins **46** which are disposed through openings holes **45** of container latch **40** and holes **36** of secondary lid latch **30**. Container latch **40** may be pivoted between a forward horizontal position where it is substantially parallel to the upper surface of secondary lid **24** and within partial depth cutout **25**, to a position in which it extends substantially perpendicular to the upper surface of secondary lid **24** with teeth **44(a)** extending above the surface, and to an opposite horizontal position in which it is above main body **32** of secondary latch **30**. A further container latch **40** is pivotably secured in each full depth cutout **28'** formed at the rear of secondary lid **24** via pivot pins. Container **50** may be secured to the upper surface of closed secondary lid **24** with teeth **44(a)** of container latches **40** disposed in cutouts **28** and **28'** secured over ledges **50(a)**. Container latches **40** may be pivoted to an outward position to remove teeth **44(a)** from ledges **50(a)** to allow container **50** to be removed from secondary lid **24**.

(34) With reference to FIGS. **12** and **12A** conventional buckle latch **14** is shown. Buckle latch **14** includes overhanging latch hook **14(a)** projecting from an upper surface and inwardly extending lateral tabs **14(c)** on each side. Holes **14(b)** are formed through each inwardly extending tab **14(c)**. Buckle latch **14** also includes lower tab **14(d)**. Latch adapter **140** includes two vertically extending side portions **140(a)** with integrally formed rectangular block **140(b)** extending therebetween. Latch adapter **140** is slidably disposed on storage container **10** via side portions **140(a)** which are slidably received in channels formed on front side **15** of storage container **10**. Metal ring **141** is secured on interior surfaces of vertical side portions **140(a)** and extends through a channel formed in rectangular block **140(b)**. Rectangular block **140(b)** includes two indented regions **140(c)** on the upper surface. Two tabs **10(a)** extend outwardly from storage body **10**. Buckle latch **14** is secured on latch adapter **140** with the lower ends of metal ring **141** disposed through holes **14(b)** to allow buckle latch **14** to pivot relative to adapter **140** and storage body **10**.

(35) In order to secure main lid **20** to storage container **10**, right buckle latch **14** and adapter **140** are moved upwardly to allow hook **14(a)** of right buckle latch **14** to be disposed over and behind main lid ledge **21(b)**. Latch buckle tab **14(d)** of right buckle latch **14** is then pushed inwardly to secured hook **14(a)** in contact with and behind right main lid ledge **21(b)** to secure main lid **20** to storage body **10**. Similarly, latch buckle tab **14(d)** of left buckle latch **14** would be contact with and behind left main lid ledge **21(a)**. In this situation secondary lid **24** can still be pivoted upwardly by independent operation of secondary lid latch **30** to separately release secondary lid **24** from main lid **20**, while main lid **20** remains secured to storage body **10** by both buckle latches **14**. Upward movement of each buckle latch **14** is precluded due to contact of tabs **10(a)** with latch block **140(b)** in order to ensure that hook **14(a)** remains secured behind lid ledge **21(b)**. To release each latch buckle **14**, latch lower tabs **14(d)** may be pulled outwardly to allow blocks **140(b)** to be removed from contact with tabs **141**. Latch buckle **14** can then be raised slightly to allow hooks **14(a)** to be removed from ledges **21(a)** and **21(b)** to thereby allow main lid **20** to pivot upwardly from storage body **10**.

(36) With reference to FIGS. **13**, **14** and **16**, various modes of operation of the invention are shown. In FIG. **13**, two storage containers **50** (as shown in FIG. **16**) are shown secured on storage body **10**. Containers **50** each include a storage body **54** having a pivotable lid **52** secured thereon. Pivotable lid **50** includes container latches **40'** (having the same structure as container latches **40** described above) on both short sides thereof. Storage bodies **54** each have ledges **50(a)** disposed on the lower ends thereof at a location beneath latches **40'**. Left side storage container **50** is secured directly to main lid **20** via front and rear container latches **40** disposed on main lid **20** which are pivoted

upwardly such that teeth **44(a)** are disposed over ledges **50(a)**. Right side container **50** is secured on secondary lid **24** via front and rear container latches **40** which are disposed over ledges **50(a)**. Main lid **20** is secured to storage body **10** via buckle latches **14**. In this situation, the combined chest **1** with containers **50** secured thereon can be moved by use of telescoping extending handle **17** and wheels **11**. With reference to FIG. **14**, further containers **50** can also be stacked and secured on either or both of containers **50** shown in FIG. **13**. (Stacked container **50** is shown stacked only on left side container **50** in FIG. **14**, but a further container **50** could also be stacked on right side container **50**.)

(37) With further reference to FIG. **14**, with right side container **50** removed, secondary lid **24** can be pivoted upwardly to allow access to interior storage volume **16**, without opening main lid **20** or moving either of the left side containers **50** which remain securely attached to the left side of main lid **20**.

(38) As shown in FIG. **15A**, right side container **50** is secured on secondary lid secondary lid **24** via container latch **40** which is pivoted into its upper position with teeth **44(a)** disposed over container ledge **50(a)**. In this condition, as shown in FIG. **15B**, since upper portion **42** and latches **44** are in physical contact with ledge **50(a)**, and since container latch **40** is physically connected to secondary lid latch **30** via pivot pins **46**, pivoting rotation of secondary lid latch **30** is precluded due to the interference of container latch **40** and ledge **50(a)**. That is, any attempt to pivot the outer portion of secondary lid latch **30** upwardly is precluded since the resultant downward motion of the inner portion of secondary lid latch **30** and container latch **40** connected thereto would be precluded by container latch **40**'s firm contact with ledge **50(a)**. Therefore, secondary lid latch lower teeth **31(a)** cannot be moved outwardly from underneath secondary lid locking ledge **29**, such that secondary lid **24** remains secured to main lid **20** and cannot be pivoted to the open state.

(39) With reference to FIG. **15C**, container latch **40** has been pivoted outwardly of container **50**, with teeth **44(a)** having been removed from behind ledge **50(a)**. Container latch **40** now rests against the upper surface **32** of secondary lid latch **30**. In this situation, since container latch **40** is no longer in contact with ledge **50(a)**, the combined secondary lid latch **30** and container latch **40** may be pivoted upwardly (clockwise in the figure) about pivot pins **35** to the position shown in FIG. **15D**. Secondary lid latch upper teeth **38** move into openings **25(a)**, while secondary lid latch lower teeth **31(a)** move outwardly of secondary lid locking ledge **29**. Therefore, secondary lid **24** may freely pivot to the open state.

(40) While the invention has been described by way of exemplary embodiments, it is understood that the words which have been used herein are words of description, rather than words of limitation. Changes may be made within the purview of the appended claims, without departing from the scope and spirit of the invention in its broader aspects.

Claims

1. A chest having: a storage body defining an interior storage volume; a main lid pivotable between a first main lid position in which said main lid covers the interior storage volume and a second main lid position in which said main lid does not cover the interior storage volume, the main lid having a main lid opening formed therethrough and a main lid ledge; a secondary lid pivotable between a first secondary lid position in which said secondary lid covers said main lid opening and a second secondary lid position in which said secondary lid does not cover said main lid opening to allow access to said interior storage volume while said main lid is in said first main lid position; a secondary lid latch secured to said secondary lid, said secondary lid latch movable between a first secondary lid latch position in which said secondary lid latch secures said secondary lid to said main lid and a second secondary lid latch position in which said secondary lid latch does not secure said secondary lid to said main lid; a container latch secured to said secondary lid latch, said container latch movable between a first container latch position in which said secondary latch is

precluded from moving between the first secondary lid latch position and the second secondary latch position and a second container latch position in which said secondary latch is not precluded from moving between the first secondary lid latch position and the second secondary latch position.

2. The chest recited in claim 1, said secondary lid including a secondary lid cutout region, said secondary lid latch pivotably secured in said secondary lid cutout region.

3. The chest recited in claim 2, said secondary lid latch including a main body and a first and a second secondary lid upper projecting arm extending on either side of said main body, said container latch pivotably secured on either side thereof in said projecting arms and extending above said main body.

4. The chest recited in claim 3, wherein, when said container latch is in the first container latch position it extends upwardly from said secondary lid main body and when said container latch is in the second container position it extends substantially horizontally over said main body.

5. The chest recited in claim 4, said container latch including an inwardly extending tooth, said tooth disposable above a step formed in a container to thereby secure said container to said secondary lid.

6. The chest recited in claim 5, said storage body including a latch buckle disposed thereon, said latch buckle removably disposable over said main lid ledge to secure said main lid to said storage body.

7. The chest recited in claim 1, said storage body including a latch buckle disposed thereon, said latch buckle removably disposable over said main lid ledge to secure said main lid to said storage body.

8. The chest recited in claim 1, said secondary lid latch including a main body and a second secondary lid latch arm extending on at least one side of said main body, said secondary lid latch arm including an inwardly extending tooth, said secondary lid including a secondary lid cutout region and a ledge disposed over said secondary lid cutout region, wherein when said secondary lid latch is in the first secondary lid latch position said tooth is disposed below said ledge and said secondary lid latch may be moved to said second position in which said tooth is not disposed below said ledge.

9. A chest comprising: a storage body defining an interior storage volume; a main lid having a main lid opening formed therethrough; a secondary lid disposed on said main lid and movable between a first secondary lid position where said secondary lid covers said main lid opening and a second secondary lid position where said secondary lid does not cover said main lid opening; a first latch disposed on said secondary lid, said first latch configured to releasably secure an external container to said secondary lid; and a second latch movable between a first latch position in which said second latch secures said secondary lid in the first secondary lid position and a second latch position in which said second latch does not secure said secondary lid in the first secondary lid position, wherein the first latch is pivotably secured on the second latch.

10. The chest recited in claim 9, wherein, when the external container is secured to said secondary lid, said second latch cannot move between the first secondary latch position and the second secondary latch position.

11. The chest recited in claim 10, wherein said first latch includes a tooth and said container having a step, wherein said tooth is disposed above said step to secure the external container to said secondary lid in the first latch position, and when said tooth is disposed above said step said secondary latch is precluded from moving to said second latch position.

12. The chest recited in claim 10, said main lid movable between a first main lid position in which said main lid covers at least a portion of said interior storage volume and a second main lid position in which said main lid does not cover said interior storage volume, said chest further comprising a buckle latch releasably securing main lid in said first main lid position.

13. The chest recited in claim 9, said main lid movable between a first main lid position in which said main lid covers at least a portion of said interior storage volume and a second main lid position

in which said main lid does not cover said interior storage volume, said chest further comprising a buckle latch releasably securing main lid in said first main lid position.

14. A stackable system including a chest and a container: said container comprising a step; and said chest comprising: a storage body defining an interior storage volume; a main lid pivotable between a first main lid position in which said main lid covers at least a portion of the interior storage volume and a second main lid position in which said main lid does not cover the interior storage volume, the main lid having a main lid opening formed therethrough and a main lid ledge; a secondary lid pivotable between a first secondary lid position in which said secondary lid covers said main lid opening and a second secondary lid position in which said secondary lid does not cover said main lid opening to allow access to said interior storage volume via said main lid opening while said main lid is in said first main lid position; a secondary lid latch secured to said secondary lid, said secondary lid latch movable between a first secondary lid latch position in which said secondary lid latch secures said secondary lid to said main lid and a second secondary lid latch position in which said secondary lid latch does not secure said secondary lid to said main lid; a container latch secured to said secondary lid, said container latch including a latch tooth, said container latch movable between a first container latch position in which said latch tooth may overlie said step to secure said container to said secondary lid when said container is disposed on said secondary lid and a second position in which said latch tooth does not overlie said step to allow said container to be removed from said secondary lid; wherein, when said container latch is in the first container latch position with said container disposed on said secondary lid, said secondary lid latch is precluded from moving between the first secondary lid latch position and the second secondary lid latch position.

15. The stackable system recited in claim 14, said chest further comprising a buckle latch releasably securing said main lid in said first main lid position.

16. The stackable system recited in claim 14, said secondary lid including a secondary lid cutout region, said secondary lid latch pivotably secured in said secondary lid cutout region.

17. The stackable system recited in claim 16, said secondary lid latch including a main body portion and a first and a second secondary lid upper projecting arm extending on either side of said main body portion, said container latch pivotably secured on either side thereof in said projecting arms and extending above said main body portion.

18. The stackable system recited in claim 17, wherein, when said container latch is in the first container latch position it extends upwardly from said secondary lid main body portion and when said container latch is in the second container latch position it extends substantially horizontally over said main body portion.

19. The stackable system recited in claim 17, said container latch including an inwardly extending tooth, said tooth disposable above said step to thereby secure said container to said secondary lid.
